

Station 1: Critical Thinking

Activity: Priority Diamond -

Instructions:

You have 9 quotes and, together, you must arrange them in a **diamond-shaped grid** by **relative importance** or relevance, usually like this:

Top position: most important

Middle: moderate importance

Bottom: least important

Developing Critical Thinking Skills

As you engage in this activity, you'll be using key critical thinking skills:

1. **Analysis**

Carefully examine each text. What does it mean? What are its implications? You'll need to compare ideas, even when they seem abstract or in conflict.

2. **Evaluation**

Decide which items are most important by making judgments based on specific or shared criteria. Be prepared to explain your reasoning.

3. **Justification**

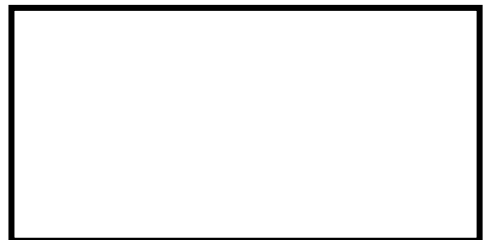
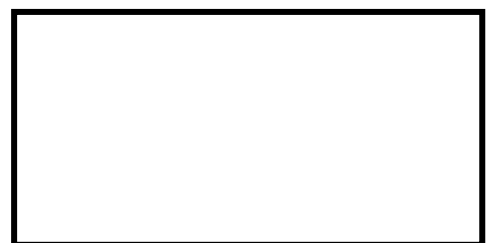
Work with your group to discuss and defend your choices. Be ready to explain *why* you've placed items in certain positions—and stay open to changing your mind.

4. **Perspective-taking**

Listen to others in your group. Different people may value different things. Respectfully consider these viewpoints to deepen your understanding and broaden your thinking.

5. **Metacognition**

Reflect on your own decision-making. What influenced your priorities? Why did you choose one item over another? This helps build awareness of your own thought processes.



Station 2: Collaboration

Activity: Consensus Challenge – School Budget Cuts

Scenario: Your school must reduce its budget by 15%. Options include cutting clubs, increasing class sizes, or reducing tech spending.

Instructions:

- Each group member is assigned a **role**:

1. *Teacher (concerned about class size and teaching quality)*
2. *Parent (focused on student well-being and enrichment)*
3. *Student Representative (values clubs and technology)*
4. *Principal (responsible for budget and performance targets)*
5. *School Business Manager (focused on long-term cost-efficiency)*

- Negotiate a shared proposal that balances competing interests.

Your goal: Reach a consensus on a cost-saving plan that reflects all viewpoints as fairly as possible.

Prepare a **group statement** summarizing:

- *Your chosen cuts*
- *Why those options were selected*
- *How you addressed each stakeholder's concerns*

Station 3: Creativity

Activity: Design a Learning Experience

Scenario: You're tasked with redesigning a typical lesson—for example, "Causes of WWII"—but with a twist:

No direct instruction, textbooks, or passive content delivery.

Your goal is to create a **student-centered, engaging** learning experience that promotes **inquiry, participation, and deep understanding**.

Instructions:

1. **Pick a Common Topic** (e.g., WWII causes, photosynthesis, Shakespearean drama, fractions).
2. **Redesign the lesson** using **non-traditional** or **creative formats** only.
3. **Sketch your design** using words, diagrams, or a quick storyboard on chart paper or a worksheet:
 - **Objective:** What should students understand or be able to do?
 - **Activity flow:** What will students actually **do** during the lesson?
 - **Materials needed:** What tools, space, or time is required?
 - **Assessment:** How will you know if they learned it?
4. **Prepare a 1-minute pitch** to summarize your redesigned experience for the next group or facilitator.

Station 4: Communication

Activity: Explaining Complex Ideas Simply

Scenario: Select an academic concept (e.g., cognitive dissonance, exponential growth).

Instructions:

- Explain the concept to a 5th grader using **analogies** and **examples**.
- Then explain it to a peer in your group.

Please choose 1 topic from the following:

Climate change

Vaccination

Evolution

Democracy

Propaganda

Taxation

Algorithms

Responsibility

Stretch your communication skills by translating complexity into clarity without losing meaning.

